PROFESSIONAL ENGLISH

Vocabulary Guide for Interviews & the Workplace

Designed for Intermediate Learners • Tech & AI Professionals

📌 **How to use this guide:**
Study one section per day • Say each example sentence aloud • Use new words in real conversations

👤 SECTION 1 — Describing Yourself & Your Skills

Use these words when answering 'Tell me about yourself' or 'What are your strengths?'

WORD / PHRASE	بالعربية	MEANING	EXAMPLE SENTENCE
analytical	تحليلي	good at examining data and solving problems logically	*I have an analytical mindset — I always look at data before making decisions.*
proficient in	متمكن من	having a good skill level in something	*I am proficient in Python and have used it in several AI projects.*
self-motivated	مندفع ذاتياً	able to work hard without being told to	*I am self-motivated — I started learning LLMs on my own before my degree.*
collaborative	تعاوني	enjoying working with others as a team	*I am collaborative and enjoy sharing ideas with my teammates.*
adaptable	قابل للتكيف	able to change and learn quickly in new situations	*I am adaptable — I learned Docker quickly when the project required it.*
detail-oriented	دقيق في التفاصيل	paying careful attention to small details	*I am detail-oriented, which helps me write clean, bug-free code.*
driven	طموح / محفوز	very motivated and determined to succeed	*I am driven to build AI systems that solve real problems.*
resourceful	مبتكر في الحلول	good at finding solutions with limited resources	*I was resourceful in building the CNN classifier with a small dataset.*
proactive	استباقي	taking action before being asked; not waiting for others	*I am proactive — I always research problems before the team meeting.*
hands-on	عملي / تطبيقي	learning or working by doing, not just reading	*I prefer a hands-on approach — I learn best by building real projects.*

💼 SECTION 2 — Talking About Your Experience & Projects

Use these verbs and phrases when describing what you did in a project or job.

WORD / PHRASE	بالعربية	MEANING	EXAMPLE SENTENCE
developed	طوّر / بنى	built or created something (software, system, model)	*I developed a CNN model to classify medicinal plants from images.*
implemented	نفّذ / طبّق	put a plan or system into action	*I implemented rate limiting to protect the LLM API from overuse.*
integrated	دمج / ربط	combined different systems or tools together	*I integrated an LLM interface into the web platform.*
optimized	حسّن / طوّر	improved something to make it faster or more efficient	*I optimized the model accuracy by applying data augmentation techniques.*
deployed	نشر / أطلق	made software or a model available to use in production	*I deployed the application using Docker and Docker Compose.*
collaborated on	تعاون على	worked on something together with a team	*I collaborated on the infrastructure setup with other engineers.*
led	قاد / أدار	was in charge of or guided a team or project	*I led the AI module development for the ft_transcendence project.*
designed	صمّم / خطّط	planned the structure or architecture of something	*I designed the overall pipeline for the RAG-based chatbot.*
evaluated	قيّم / اختبر	measured the performance or quality of something	*I evaluated the model using precision, recall, and F1 score.*
troubleshot	عالج الأخطاء	found and fixed problems in a system	*I troubleshot a critical bug in the IRC server under high load.*

⬆️ SECTION 3 — Upgrade Your Words (Weak → Strong)

These small changes make you sound much more professional and confident in interviews.

Say it stronger — upgrade these common phrases

	❌ Instead of saying...		✅ Say this instead
	I did the project.	✓	I developed and delivered the project end-to-end.
	I helped with AI stuff.	✓	I contributed to the AI module, focusing on LLM integration.
	I know Python.	✓	I am proficient in Python with hands-on experience in ML pipelines.
	I made a model.	✓	I designed and trained a CNN model for image classification.

	I fixed some bugs.	✓	I troubleshot and resolved critical performance issues in the system.
	I worked with Docker.	✓	I deployed multi-container infrastructure using Docker and Docker Compose.
	I think I'm good at problem solving.	✓	I have demonstrated strong problem-solving skills across multiple projects.
	I want to learn more.	✓	I am committed to continuous learning and professional growth.
	My weakness is I work too much.	✓	I sometimes prioritize depth over speed — I'm working on balancing both.
	I want this job because it's interesting.	✓	I am drawn to this role because of the opportunity to drive AI innovation at scale.

🎤 SECTION 4 — Interview Sentence Starters

These phrases help you begin answers professionally. Memorize 2–3 from each group.

When describing your experience:

- **In my experience, ...**
  → *"In my experience, building real projects teaches more than textbooks."*
- **One example of this is when I ...**
  → *"One example of this is when I integrated streaming into the LLM interface."*
- **During my time at [project/school], ...**
  → *"During my time at 1337 Coding School, I built production-level systems."*
- **I have had the opportunity to ...**
  → *"I have had the opportunity to work on AI, DevOps, and backend systems."*

When answering 'Why do you want this job?':

- **I am particularly drawn to this role because ...**
  → *"I am particularly drawn to this role because of CDG's national impact."*
- **What excites me most about this position is ...**
  → *"What excites me most is the chance to build AI tools that affect millions."*
- **I believe my background in ... aligns well with ...**
  → *"I believe my background in LLMs aligns well with your AI strategy."*

When you need time to think:

- **That's a great question. Let me think for a moment...**
  → *Gives you 5 seconds — sounds professional, not nervous.*
- **Could you clarify what you mean by ...?**
  → *Asking for clarification is smart, not weak.*
- **If I understand correctly, you are asking about ...**

→ *Shows you are listening carefully.*

✨ SECTION 5 — Power Adjectives for Professional English

Use these to describe your work, ideas, and solutions — they make you sound senior and confident.

WORD / PHRASE	بالعربية	MEANING	EXAMPLE SENTENCE
robust	متين / موثوق	strong and reliable, not easy to break	*I built a robust error-handling system for the LLM interface.*
scalable	قابل للتوسع	can grow bigger without losing performance	*The architecture is scalable — it can handle 10x more users.*
efficient	فعّال / كفء	doing something well without wasting time/resources	*The pipeline is efficient — it processes data in under 2 seconds.*
comprehensive	شامل / متكامل	covering everything, very complete	*I conducted a comprehensive analysis of the dataset before training.*
streamlined	مبسّط / محسّن	made simpler and faster by removing unnecessary steps	*I streamlined the deployment process using Docker Compose.*
impactful	مؤثر / ذو أثر	having a strong positive effect	*This RAG system would be highly impactful for CDG's document search.*
cutting-edge	متطور / حديث جداً	the most modern and advanced	*I have hands-on experience with cutting-edge LLM technologies.*
end-to-end	من البداية للنهاية	covering the full process from start to finish	*I took ownership of the end-to-end development of the classifier.*
seamless	سلس / بدون انقطاع	smooth, with no problems or interruptions	*The integration was seamless — users noticed no downtime.*
measurable	قابل للقياس	can be counted or tracked with numbers	*The improvement in accuracy was measurable: from 72% to 91%.*

🤖 SECTION 6 — AI & Tech Vocabulary in Professional English

When you explain technical topics in an interview, use these phrases to sound clear and professional.

WORD / PHRASE	بالعربية	MEANING	EXAMPLE SENTENCE
leverage	الاستفادة من	to use something to its maximum advantage	*We can leverage RAG to give the LLM access to live company data.*

pipeline	خط معالجة / مسار	a set of steps that data or tasks move through	*I built a data pipeline that runs nightly using Apache Airflow.*
bottleneck	نقطة اختناق	the slowest part of a process that limits speed	*The main bottleneck was the embedding step — I optimized it with batching.*
latency	زمن الاستجابة	the delay or waiting time in a system	*Streaming responses reduced perceived latency for the user.*
throughput	معدل الإنتاجية	the amount of data or tasks processed per unit time	*We improved throughput by parallelizing the preprocessing steps.*
inference	استدلال / تنبؤ	running a trained model to make predictions	*The model runs inference in under 100ms per image.*
fine-tune	ضبط دقيق	to make small adjustments to improve performance	*We fine-tuned the base model on domain-specific financial data.*
hallucination	هلوسة النموذج	when an LLM generates false but confident information	*RAG reduces hallucination by grounding responses in real documents.*
orchestrate	تنسيق / إدارة	to manage and coordinate multiple systems or tasks	*Airflow orchestrates our nightly ETL and model retraining jobs.*
proof of concept	إثبات الفكرة	a small test to show an idea can work	*I built a proof of concept for the RAG chatbot in two days.*

📝 SECTION 7 — Full Interview Answer Examples

Study these complete answers. Notice how many vocabulary words from this guide are used together.

Q: Tell me about a project you are proud of.

Strong Answer using professional vocabulary:
"I'm particularly proud of the Medicinal Plant CNN Classifier I developed. The challenge was that I had an imbalanced dataset — some species had very few images. I took a proactive approach: I implemented data augmentation techniques and used a weighted loss function to handle the imbalance. The result was measurable — model accuracy improved from around 70% to over 90%. I managed the end-to-end development, from data collection to model evaluation, which gave me a comprehensive understanding of the full ML lifecycle."

💡 **Tip:** Count the power words used: proactive, implemented, measurable, end-to-end, comprehensive. Aim for 3–5 per answer.

Q: How do you handle a problem you've never seen before?

Strong Answer:
"When I face an unfamiliar problem, I take a structured approach. First, I break it down analytically to understand the root cause. Then I leverage available resources — documentation, research papers, or community forums. During the ft_transcendence project, I had never built an LLM interface with streaming before. I researched the API specifications, built a proof of concept, then iterated until I had a robust, production-ready solution with proper error handling and rate limiting. I find that being resourceful and methodical helps me solve most novel challenges efficiently."

📅 SECTION 8 — Your 7-Day Practice Plan

Follow this plan to build your vocabulary before your CDG interview:

DAY	TASK
Day 1	Study Section 1 (describing yourself). Say each word aloud 3 times. Write 2 sentences about yourself using new words.
Day 2	Study Section 2 (experience verbs). Rewrite your 3 project descriptions using the new verbs.
Day 3	Study Section 3 (upgrades). Take 5 weak sentences you use normally and upgrade them.
Day 4	Study Section 4 (sentence starters). Practice answering 'Tell me about yourself' using 3 starters.
Day 5	Study Sections 5 & 6 (adjectives + tech). Describe your CNN project and LLM project using power adjectives.
Day 6	Read Section 7 (full examples) aloud 3 times. Record yourself and listen back.
Day 7	Full mock interview day — answer all 6 common questions from your CDG prep guide using words from this guide.

💡 **Tip:** The fastest way to learn vocabulary is to USE it — don't just read. Write sentences, say them aloud, and use them in real conversations or messages every day.

You already have great skills. Now give them the words they deserve. 💪